

2026 Social Media Guidelines

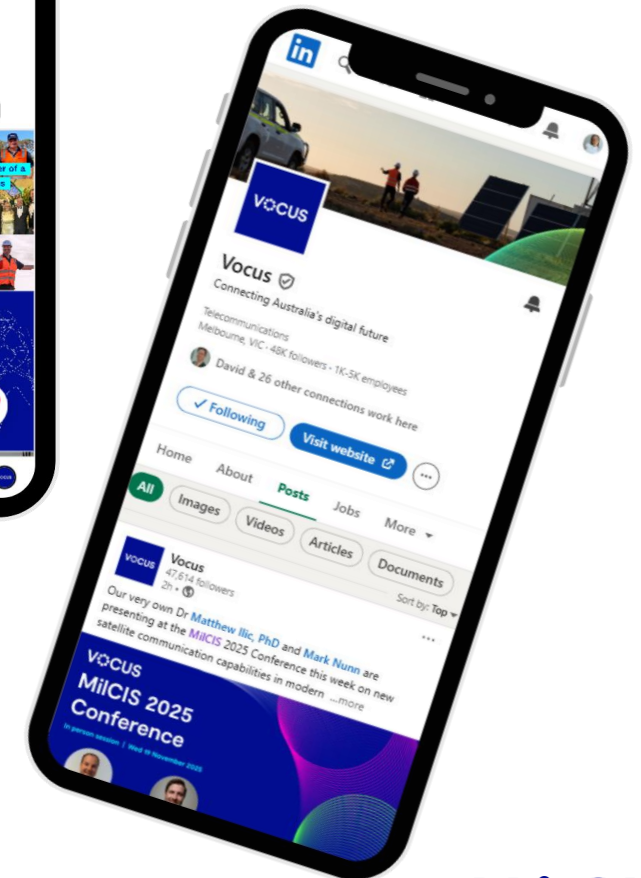
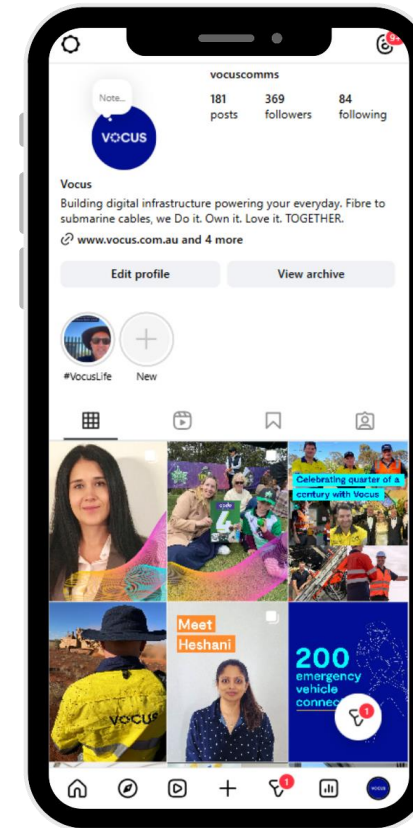
Overview

Social media is often the first impression people have of Vocus, whether they are potential customers, future employees, industry partners or stakeholders. That first impression matters, and these guidelines help ensure every post reflects the authentic voice that defines who we are. Vocus should make complex infrastructure accessible, showcasing real customer outcomes and the human side of our business. Inconsistent messaging or off-brand visuals can damage credibility and confuse audiences about what we stand for.

These guidelines aren't restrictions - they're tools to help you create better content faster. When everyone follows the same standards, our collective voice becomes stronger, our brand becomes more recognisable and our message cuts through the noise.

This document covers everything from tone and style for each platform, to technical requirements, approval processes and practical examples of what works.

Refer to it before creating content, not after - it's designed to set you up for success from the start.



Approvals & governance

Ownership Social media is managed by the Communications team. Content can be created by all team members, but platforms and posts are owned by the Social Media Manager.

Approval requirements

- All posts: **Head of Communications** approval required
- Major announcements, sensitive topics, executive content, legal matters: **GM of Communications approval also required**
- Allow 24-48 hours for standard approval; 1-2 days for GM approval
- When in doubt, ask first

Platforms & tools



Canva - Social media graphics using approved templates only



Adobe Creative Cloud - Professional design (graphic designer only)



Microsoft ClipChamp - Video editing and captions (mandatory for all videos)



Asana - Content planner and calendar (all content must be briefed here)

Content workflow

1. **Brief** → Submit in Asana Comms Tracker
2. **Create** → Use Canva templates or ClipChamp
3. **Approve** → Social Media Manager then Head of Comms (+ GM where necessary)
4. **Schedule** → Social Media Manager schedules
5. **Post** → Content goes live
6. **Monitor** → Track and respond to engagement
7. **Report** → Add posted link to Asana task

Urgent content: Flag as URGENT in Asana + contact Social Media Manager directly

Platform access

Social Media Manager: Full admin access, scheduling, publishing

Communications Team: Canva, ClipChamp, Asana access

Other team members: Submit content ideas/requests via Asana

Questions? Contact Social Media Manager or Head of Communications

Tone & style guide

Overall brand voice

Vocus communicates with confidence and clarity. We're experts in complex infrastructure, but we make it accessible. Our tone is professional yet conversational, informative without being corporate and engaging without being gimmicky.

Key principles:

- **Short, punchy sentences** - We don't write long, flowing paragraphs. We break ideas into digestible chunks.
- **No corporate jargon** - Never start with "At Vocus" or use formulaic phrases like "We're excited to announce"
- **Show value, don't just inform** - Every post should explain why what we're doing matters to our business and customers
- **Be human** - Write like you're talking to someone you know, not issuing a press release
- **Australian English** - We use Australian spelling and terminology (e.g., "organised" not "organized", "centre" not "center") - make sure if using AI to support writing that you edit so it sounds authentic

Content planning & workflow

Before you start writing:

- All social media content must be briefed through the **Comms Tracker in Asana**
- This ensures proper approval workflows and scheduling coordination
- Include key details: platform, topic, timing and any assets needed

Visual Requirements:

- All images must be designed using **approved templates for B2B and B2C**
- Templates are available in Canva or send a request to the Graphic Designer
- Contact the design team if you need new templates or have questions about asset requirements
- Never post without properly branded visuals that match our style guidelines



[Asana Comms Tracker](#)



Tone: Professional, informative, strategic

Length: 150-250 words typically

Structure: Hook → Context → Why it matters to Vocus or why someone should care → CTA

Audience: It's a large audience base. Write for all audiences. If it is for a specific sub-audience then make sure that is stated in the copy. We don't sell on LinkedIn, we tell a story that gives our audience value. Always review with that lens.

Key characteristics:

- Open with an engaging hook that grabs attention
- Use shorter sentences and paragraphs for readability
- Always include a "why this matters to Vocus" section that explains our strategic positioning
- Avoid repetitive structures like "For Vocus, this demonstrates..."
- End with clear CTAs
- Use 2-3 relevant hashtags including #OurPeopleAreTheDifference or #ConnectingAustralia



Vocus
49,477 followers
6d • 🌐

For [VetPartners Australia and New Zealand](#), operating more than 270 veterinary clinics across 3 countries means technology plays a critical role in day-to-day operations, from booking systems to imaging. In partnership with [Fortinet](#), we delivered a managed SD-WAN network that simplified their environment and created a scalable, reliable foundation.

By working closely together, the teams were able to deliver at pace, supporting clinicians with the technology they rely on every day.

Watch the video to learn more 🎥 and visit our website for the case study: <https://lnkd.in/gqhMvPAr>



Auto captions have been added to your video



Edit captions

👤👤👤 Stacey Caia and 85 others

6 comments · 6 reposts



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Our Chief Information & Transformation Officer, [Rob Ison](#), explains how our engineering teams are using AI to deliver new capabilities faster, cutting proof-of-concept time from days to hours while maintaining rigorous review and testing on every line of code.

Speed matters. Quality matters more.

#AI #DigitalInfrastructure #ConnectingAustralia



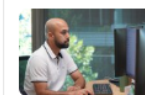
Rob Ison • 2nd
Chief information Officer, Vocus
2mo • Edited • 🌐

Speed matters in digital infrastructure – but not at the cost of quality. [Vocus](#) is using AI across our software engineering teams to deliver faster for customers, but we're being deliberate about keeping human review and accountability at the centre of everything we ship.

Our pilot using Amazon Q Developer as an AI coding assistant has delivered more than 50 per cent productivity improvement across our engineering teams. Proof-of-concept work that used to take days is now happening in under a day.

But every line of AI-generated code goes through the same rigorous review and testing as human-written code. No exceptions.

Australia's demand for digital infrastructure is accelerating. Vocus is building ahead of that demand – and improving how we work internally to keep pace. <https://lnkd.in/gajzYrsa>



How Vocus is using AI to deliver faster, without cutting corners | [Vocus Blog](#) | Vocus
vocus.com.au

👤👤👤 Gemma Blythe and 60 others

3 reposts





Tone: Conversational, visual-first, energetic

Length: 80-120 words maximum

Structure: Hook → Key message → CTA

Key characteristics:

- Much shorter than LinkedIn - Instagram is mobile-first
- Use emojis sparingly and only when contextually appropriate
- Focus on visual storytelling - the image/video does the heavy lifting
- Break into very short paragraphs (1-2 sentences max)
- Conversational without being overly casual
- Use 1-3 relevant hashtags including #OurPeopleAreTheDifference or #ThroughTheVocusLens



vocuscomms

Original audio



vocuscomms #TakeFive with Dan! 🎬

We found Dan from our Communications team preparing for a meeting so we jumped in to ask him 5 quick questions about life at Vocus.

From liaising with journalists to crafting key messages for the business, Dan's behind the scenes shaping how we tell our story while we build Australia's digital infrastructure.

Ready to get to know the people powering our network? Watch now! 👉

#teamvocus

10w



vocuscomms Meet Dave, our Head of Brand and Integrated Marketing. Seven years ago, he joined the team as Digital Content Manager working with our iconic consumer brands, @dodoaustralia and @iprimusau

Since then, he's progressed from creating digital campaigns to leading large-scale, high-impact marketing initiatives, guiding a talented team and shaping the customer experience across every touchpoint.

Today, Dave's focus is on helping our customers and building strong brands, proving that passion, dedication, and a "make it happen" mindset can take you far at Vocus.

See how Dave turned opportunity into impact, link in bio!

10w



Tone: Professional, authentic, storytelling-focused

Length: Variable (2-5 minutes for general content, 30-60 seconds for Shorts)

Structure: Hook → Story/Context → Impact → CTA

Key characteristics:

- Authentic storytelling - let customers and employees tell their stories
- Professional production quality reflecting our brand standards
- Longer-form content allows deeper exploration than other platforms
- Show real outcomes and impact, not just features
- Strong visual storytelling - demonstrate our work in action
- Include captions/transcripts for accessibility (mandatory)

Playlists

Life at Vocus

Culture in action. Team moments. Community impact. What it looks like when connectivity enables potential — together. #VocusLife

Industry insights & thought leadership

Vocus leaders explore the hard questions shaping digital infrastructure. They talk everything from subsea innovation to evolving market demands. Perspectives on where connectivity is heading.

How we connect

50,000km of fibre. 15,000km of submarine cables. 20,000+ connected buildings. How we build and operate the digital infrastructure that supports what's coming next, not just what exists today.

Our people, our stories

Meet the people powering our network across Australia. Real careers, real journeys and what it actually means to grow with Vocus. #VocusLife

Events & on the ground

The conversations shaping how we think about being the trusted digital infrastructure platform for hyperscalers, carriers and enterprises. See where Vocus shows up and who we're learning from.

Vocus products

From fibre and private networks to LEO satellite and subsea cables — see how our solutions support secure, scalable connectivity for enterprise and government. Built for what's coming next.

Platform-specific don'ts

LinkedIn:

- ✗ Don't use "At Vocus" or "For Vocus" to start sentences
- ✗ Don't write long paragraphs (max 3 sentences)
- ✗ Don't repeat the same "For Vocus, this demonstrates..." structure in every post
- ✗ Don't use excessive emojis
- ✗ Don't end with questions unless specifically seeking engagement

Instagram:

- ✗ Don't write long captions that require "read more" clicks
- ✗ Don't post without strong visual content
- ✗ Don't use square or landscape images (use 4:5 portrait ratio)
- ✗ Don't overuse emojis or make posts look unprofessional
- ✗ Don't use corporate language - keep it conversational

Special considerations

Chatham House Rules: When posting about events with Chatham House rules:

- Never attribute specific insights to named individuals
- Don't quote anyone directly
- Frame insights as "themes that emerged" or "conversations focused on"
- Thank attendees collectively, not individually

example:

Key insights emerged around disaster preparedness, flexible connectivity for council fleets and library vans, and the need for alternatives to traditional providers.

Legal sensitivities:

- Avoid absolute claims like "failure is not an option"
- Don't imply competitors are consistently poor
- Use factual statements about what we provide, not subjective claims about superiority
- Rephrase if something "sounds too sales-y" or makes claims we can't substantiate

Tone comparison

Element	LinkedIn	Instagram
Sentence length	Short to medium	Very short
Paragraphs	2-4 sentences	1-2 sentences
Emojis	Minimal	Selective use
Hashtags	2-3	1-3
Technical detail	Moderate	Light
Formality	Professional conversational	Casual conversational

Quick checklist before posting

- ✓ Does it open with an engaging hook?
- ✓ Are sentences short and punchy?
- ✓ Have you avoided "At Vocus" or "For Vocus" openings?
- ✓ Is there a clear value proposition explaining why this matters?
- ✓ Does it sound conversational, not corporate?
- ✓ Are hashtags relevant and properly formatted?
- ✓ Have you checked for repetitive structures from previous posts?
- ✓ Is the CTA clear and action-oriented?



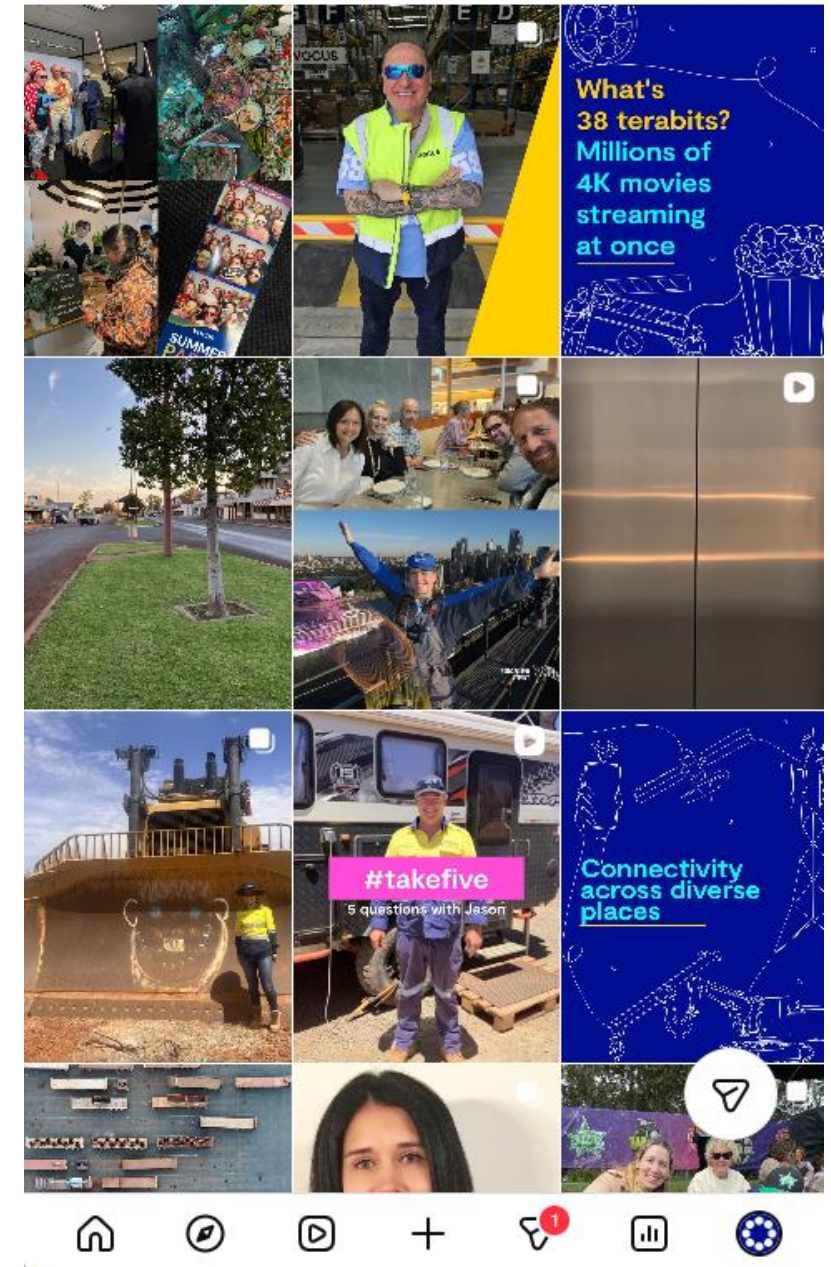
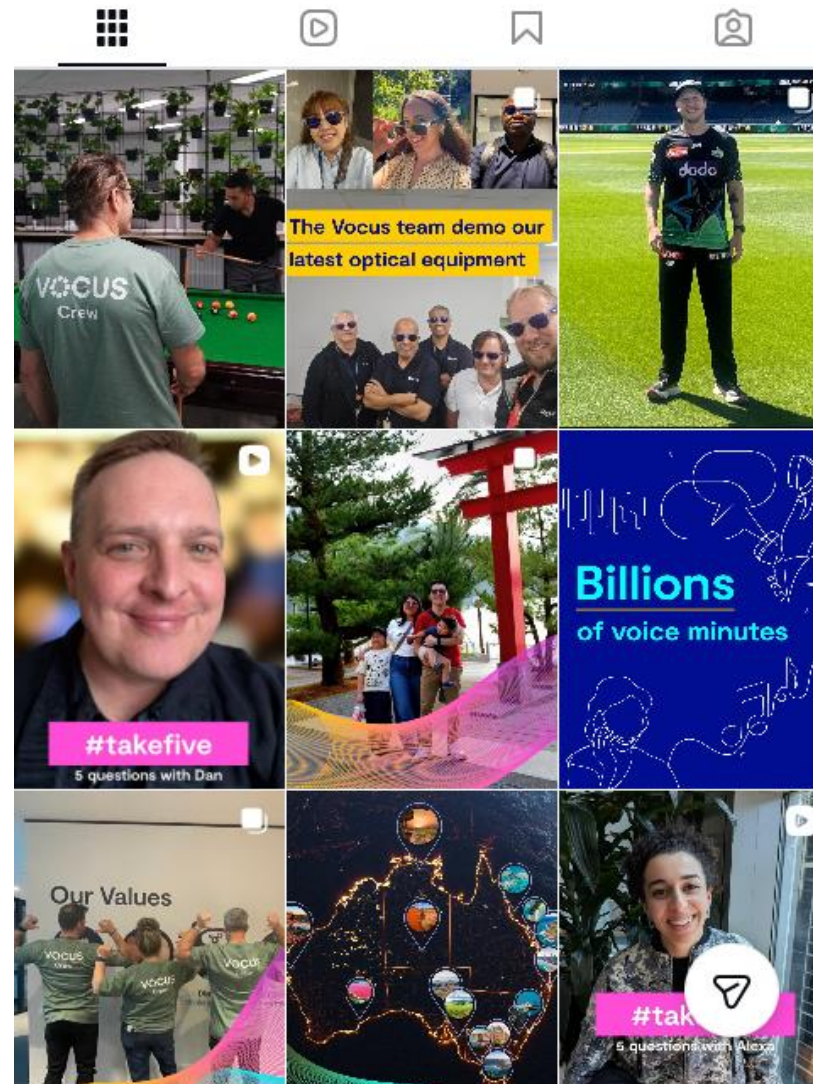
Remember

When in doubt, read it aloud. If it sounds like a press release, rewrite it. If it sounds like a conversation with someone you know about something impressive that we're doing, you're on the right track.

Layout + design - Instagram

Instagram is a visual-first platform – people judge a brand in seconds based on how the feed looks as a whole, not just individual posts. A consistent grid signals professionalism, intentionality and brand maturity. When the visual style is scattered – different colours, clashing filters, inconsistent layouts – it undermines credibility and makes the brand feel disjointed.

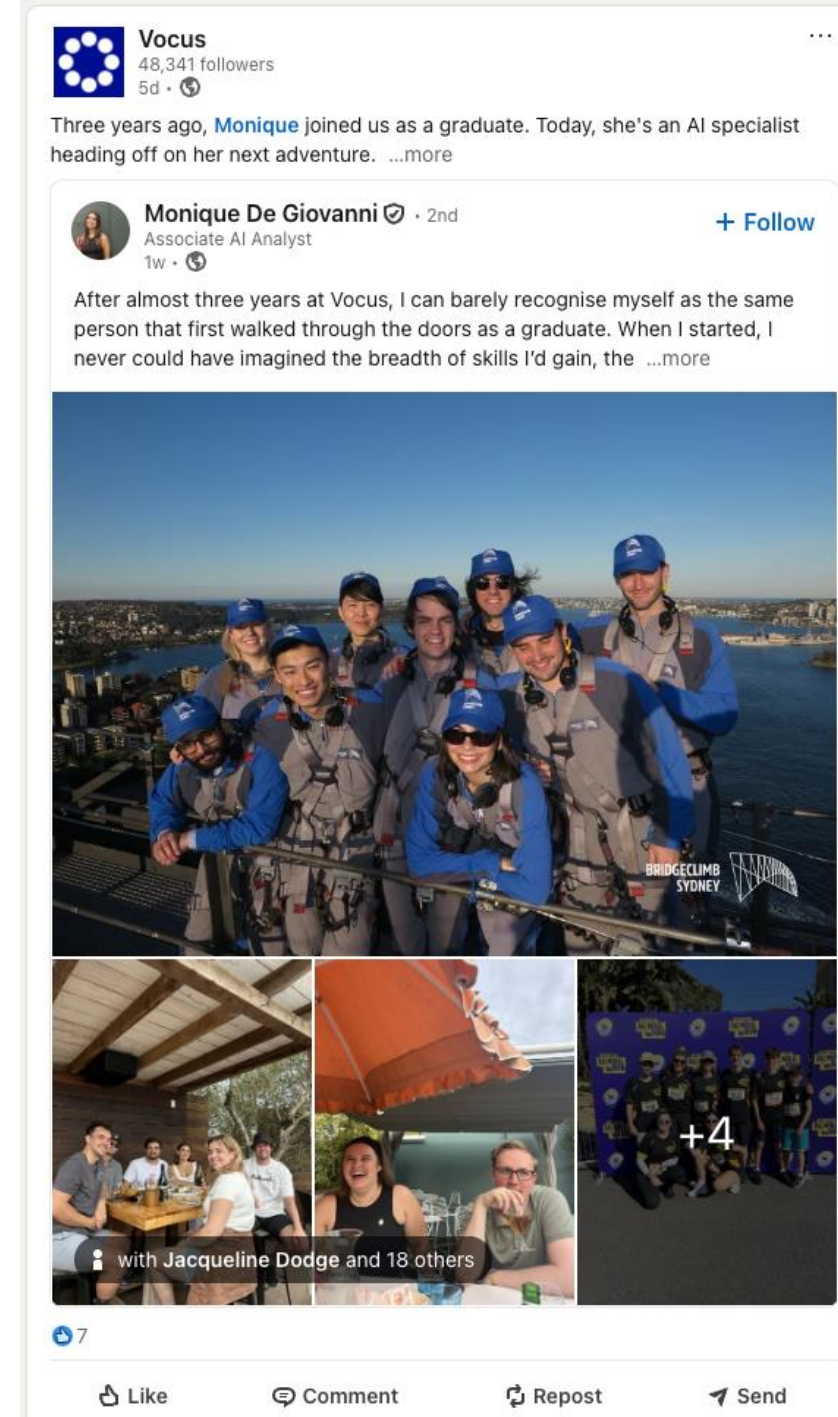
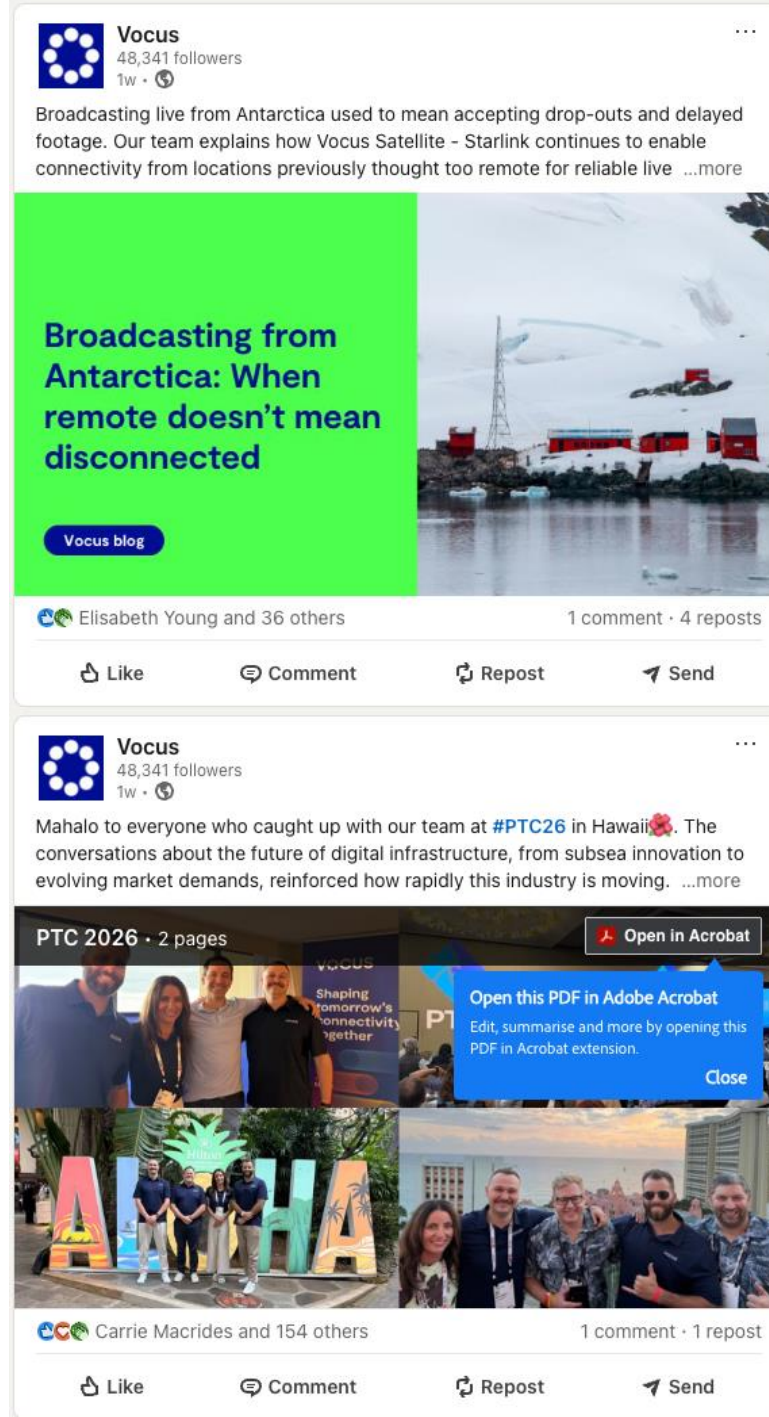
The Vocus grid is often the first impression for talent, partners, and customers checking us out. A cohesive feed reinforces that we're a company that pays attention to detail and knows who we are. It doesn't mean every post looks identical – it means there's a clear visual thread that ties everything together.



Layout + design - LinkedIn

LinkedIn is our primary B2B channel – it's where customers, partners, investors and talent come to understand who Vocus is and what we stand for. Unlike Instagram, people aren't just scrolling past; they're actively researching us before making decisions.

A consistent LinkedIn presence – from the banner and logo through to post style and messaging – builds trust and recognition over time. When the tone shifts between posts, visuals feel ad hoc, or messaging contradicts itself, it creates doubt. Consistency signals that we know our story and we're committed to it.

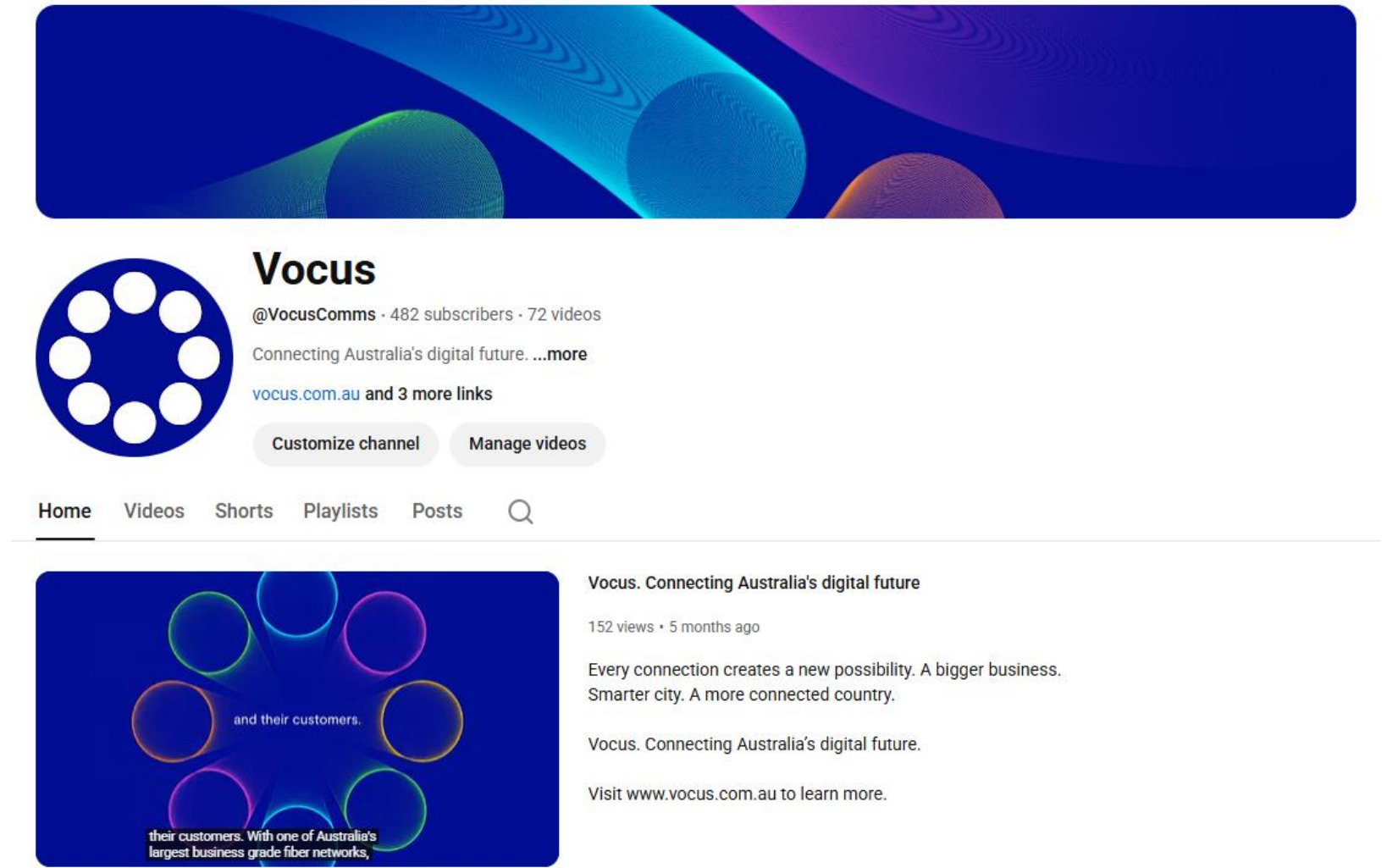


Layout + design - YouTube

YouTube is where people go to learn, not just scroll. It's a search engine as much as a social platform – which means our content lives longer and works harder than on any other channel. A video posted today can still drive views and credibility years from now.

A consistent YouTube presence – thumbnails, titles, video quality and content style – signals that we're serious about storytelling, not just posting for the sake of it. When thumbnails look inconsistent, video quality varies wildly or the channel feels abandoned, it undermines trust before anyone even hits play.

The Vocus YouTube is our opportunity to go deeper. Customer stories, infrastructure projects, leadership perspectives – the kind of content that doesn't fit in a 30-second video. A cohesive channel tells people we're investing in this, and that what they're about to watch is worth their time.



Post sizes

Instagram

Feed Posts	Stories	Reels	IGTV
Portrait: 1080 x 1350 px (4:5 aspect ratio)	1080 x 1920 px (9:16 aspect ratio)	Vertical: 1080 x 1920 px (9:16 aspect ratio) Little reels Horizontal: 5120 x 1080 px	1080 x 1920 px (9:16 aspect ratio)

LinkedIn

Feed Posts	LinkedIn stories	Company page cover	Video posts
Single image: 1200 x 1200 px (square) or 1200 x 627 px (landscape) Article header: 1200 x 627 px	1080 x 1920 px (9:16 aspect ratio)	1192 x 220 px	Minimum: 256 x 144 px Maximum: 4096 x 2304 px Recommended: 1920 x 1080 px

There are two different upload approaches on LinkedIn depending on what you're posting.

For carousel posts (multiple images), always upload as a PDF, this is what creates the swipeable format on LinkedIn. Uploading multiple JPEGs or PNGs will randomly stack them, not a carousel.

For single images, upload as a PNG.

YouTube

Thumbnails	Channel art
1280 x 720 px (16:9 aspect ratio) Minimum width: 640 px	2560 x 1440 px (safe area: 1546 x 423 px)
Video	YouTube Shorts
1920 x 1080 px (1080p HD) 1280 x 720 px (720p HD) 3840 x 2160 px (4K)	1080 x 1920 px (9:16 aspect ratio)

Captions – all platforms

Captions are mandatory on all Vocus video content. They make our content accessible, allow people to watch without sound and improve performance across every platform. Most social media videos are watched on mute. Captions ensure our message lands regardless of how someone is watching. They also support viewers with hearing impairments and help with language clarity across different accents.

How to add captions in Clipchamp

1. Import your video and add it to the timeline
2. Select the clip, then click the **Transcribe** in the tab in the property panel on the right
3. Select Generate transcript
4. Select English (United Kingdom) as the language and click **Transcribe Media** to generate
5. Review the transcript carefully and correct any spelling errors or mishearing
6. Click on the captions in the preview window to adjust style and formatting
7. Export your video — captions will be baked in

Always review captions before exporting. AI transcription is accurate but not perfect.

Our caption formatting requirements – social media

Font: Moderat or Arial

Font size: *[add size]*

Colour: White with a slight black shadow

Position: Top lower third

Background: Only if content is too light for white text can a Vocus colour bar is acceptable.

Animation: one word bounce at a time

Downloading the SRT file for YouTube

Some platforms, including YouTube, accept caption files separately rather than baked into the video. For these, download the SRT file from Clipchamp before exporting.

1. Once captions are generated and reviewed, click the **Captions** tab in the property panel
2. Select **Download Captions** — the SRT file will save to your device
3. When uploading to YouTube, go to **Subtitles** in YouTube Studio and upload the SRT file against the relevant video

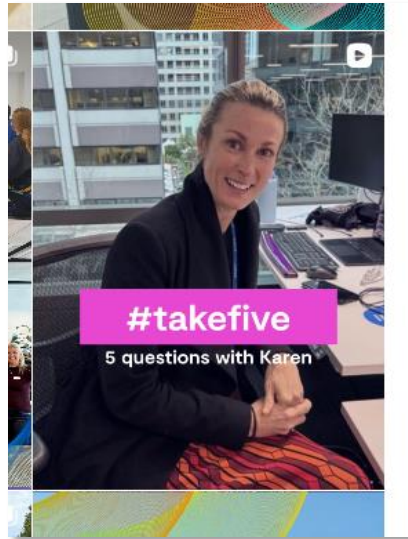
This keeps captions editable on YouTube after upload, which is useful if anything needs correcting later without re-exporting the full video.

Series snapshot

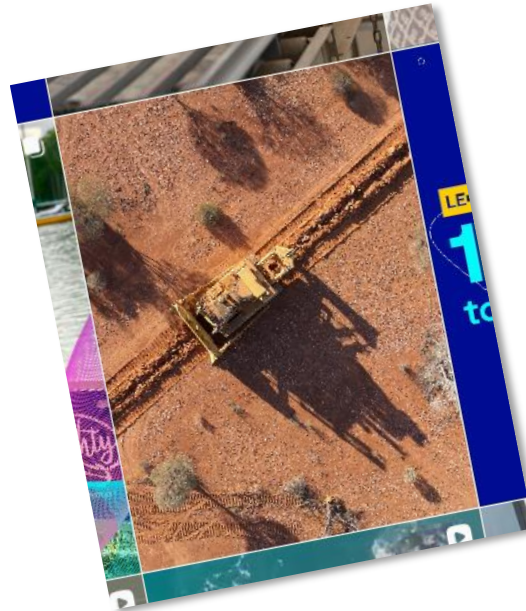
Click the names for more information.



[#DidYouKnow](#)



[#TakeFive](#)



[#ThroughTheVocusLens](#)



[People Stories](#)



[Benefits highlights](#)

VOCUS

Photography and video guidelines

Why quality visuals matter: High-quality, authentic imagery is essential to our brand perception. Social media is visual-first - people scroll past text but stop for compelling images. Poor lighting, awkward framing or unprofessional shots undermine our credibility as a leading provider. Quality photography and video directly impact engagement rates, reach and brand perception.

Brand consistency: All photos and videos must align with our approved brand guidelines. Make sure you are using branded templates, maintaining consistent style and representing our team and customers authentically.

Note on eye contact: Our brand guidelines advise against looking directly down the lens and this applies to formal brand photography. Social media is different. When capturing people at events, in the office, or as part of our people series, looking at the camera builds connection and makes our content feel human and approachable. For social, we encourage it.



Event photography & video checklist

Must-have shots

- ✓ Vocus people presenting or on-stage panels - Shows thought leadership
- ✓ Our event stand/booth (wide and detail shots) - Proves our presence
- ✓ Vocus team engaging with customers/partners - Demonstrates relationship building
- ✓ Group photos - People looking at camera, smiling (mix of large and small groups)
- ✓ Event atmosphere - Room shots showing attendees and energy
- ✓ Behind-the-scenes moments - Setup, team prep, candid interactions
- ✓ Networking moments - People mingling, coffee chats, informal conversations
- ✓ Product demos or displays (if showcasing technology/services)
- ✓ Executive/leadership shots - For corporate content

Nice-to-haves

- Speaker slides with key messages or logos
- Awards or recognition moments
- B-roll footage
- Short video clips (15-30 seconds) for Stories/Reels

Technical essentials

- ✓ Shoot both horizontal AND vertical - Vertical for Instagram (4:5 ratio), horizontal for LinkedIn
- ✓ Get close - Faces must be clearly visible on mobile screens
- ✓ Good lighting - Face windows or stage lights, avoid backlighting
- ✓ Leave space - Room for text overlays and cropping
- ✓ Keep videos short - 15-30 seconds max, steady hands
- ✓ Check audio - Get close to speakers, avoid noisy backgrounds
- ✓ Multiple angles - Same moment from different perspectives

Style notes:

- Natural, authentic moments over posed shots
- Include Vocus branding where visible
- Capture diverse mix of people and interactions
- Groups of people smiling and looking down the camera

Golden rule: Take 3x more photos than you think you need - you can't recreate moments after the event!

Tips and hints

Video & accessibility

Always include captions on any video across social media. This can be done through ClipChamp by uploading your video or editing your video in ClipChamp and enabling captions/transcript. Captions improve accessibility and engagement (most social video is watched without sound). **See captions slide above**

Formatting & technical

We don't use titles unless it is a hero or hook short sentence at the start of the post.

LinkedIn multi-image posts - Upload multiple images as a PDF document to create carousel format. This performs better than native multi-image posts.

Instagram doesn't support GIF format - Always upload as MP4 instead.

Text overlays - When adding text to images/videos, ensure sufficient contrast for readability on mobile. Use brand-approved fonts only.

Scheduling & workflow

Schedule posts where possible:

LinkedIn: can be scheduled via mobile and desktop

Instagram: can be scheduled via mobile only

Save your work - Get the posted links and place them in the Asana task so they can be kept for reference later.

Optimal posting times:

LinkedIn: Tuesday-Thursday, 8am-2pm AEDT (business hours)

Instagram: Early morning (6-9am) and evening (7-9pm)

Content quality

Emojis - Use sparingly and only when contextually appropriate. Never use in professional/serious content (e.g., announcements about serious incidents, condolences).

Proofreading - Always have someone else review your post before scheduling. Fresh eyes catch errors you'll miss.

Copyright and permissions - Never use images, graphics, or content you don't have rights to. When in doubt, ask Legal or Communications team.

Engagement & strategy

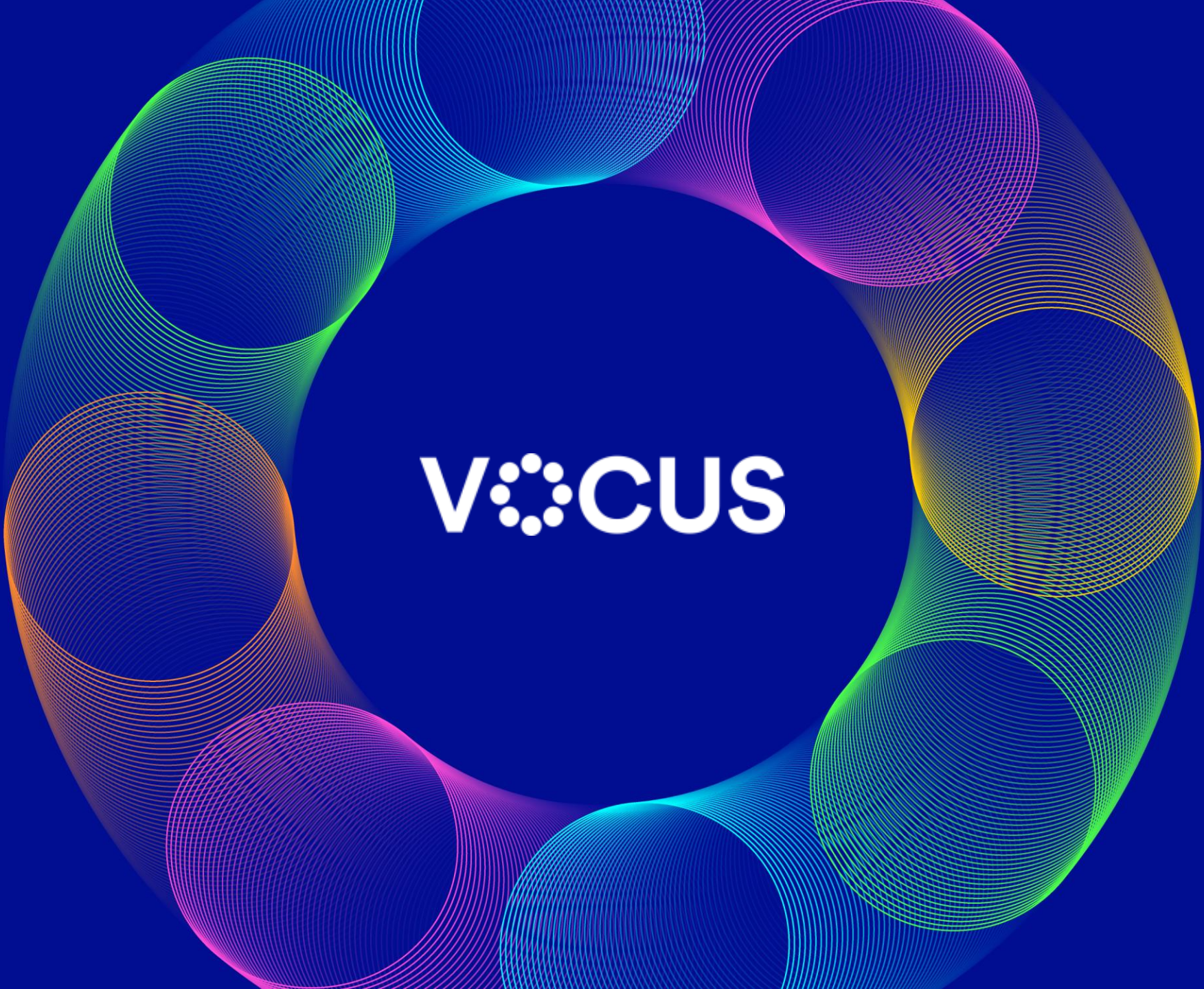
Tag strategically - Only tag people/organisations when they add value to the post. Over-tagging looks spammy and dilutes your message.

Hashtags:

Hashtags are not as effective as they used to be. In fact, many platforms don't hold value in them. Use sparingly.

Respond to comments - Monitor posts for 24-48 hours after publishing and respond to comments promptly. Engagement boosts reach.

Reposting/Resharing - When resharing another organisation's content, add your own commentary - don't just hit share. Explain why it matters to Vocus.

The image features a large, circular graphic composed of numerous overlapping, concentric circles. Each circle is formed by many closely spaced, parallel lines. The colors of these circles transition through a rainbow spectrum: starting with blue at the top, moving through green, yellow, orange, red, and finally back to blue at the bottom. The graphic is set against a solid dark blue background. In the center of the graphic, the word "VOCUS" is written in a white, sans-serif font. The "V" and "C" are larger and more prominent than the other letters, and the "O" is replaced by a cluster of small white dots.

VOCUS